

AI is extremely good for the environment

Posted by u/OkThereBro • 0 points • 7 comments

One of the most strongly held opinions about AI is that it's bad for the environment.

However I'm yet to see a single task that AI does that is not FAR more environmentally taxing to do yourself.

Images are far more efficient and environmentally friendly. Just a few hours of screentime and you're already way behind the environmental efficiency of AI.

1 AI image = <50g CO2

1 AI text message = 1-10g CO2

PC for 2 hour = <100g CO2

Unless you're a speed painter, it's just a clear win for AI. This is an example of the most strenuous task.

Anytime anyone brings up the environmental costs of AI they conveniently leave out any comparison between other methods of achieving similar goals. Because when compared, not using AI is far more costly.

AI is not cost free. But compared to doing the labor yourself the impact is literally substantially less. When you amplify this impact across the world, it's enormously beneficial for the earth.

Even just in terms of reducing screentime alone. Or speeding up tasks so those tasks take up less resources, to be more specific.

Comments

u/Person012345 • 2 points • 2025-04-29 22:47 UTC

even outside of "achieving similar goals", who the fuck is someone who drives their car to work, drives their car to the store drives their car back to their air conditioned house and puts their clean laundry in the tumble drier to judge me because I generated a few pictures of anime girls? A fuck ass hypocrite is who they are.

u/pinkenbrawn • 2 points • 2025-04-29 17:29 UTC

It's a bad faith argument for the vast majority anyway. Not ****the**** reason why they're actually against AI, just something to point to as a sort of a gotcha. Like "but the children" is a go-to for the right, like "but the environment" is for the left (I'm using the terms "left" and "right" very loosely here). Whether it's true or not, it's still used as something you would look like shit for opposing.

u/adfx • 2 points • 2025-04-29 15:58 UTC

I think AI has made me produce more CO2 though. I would not be drawing something instead of asking AI to draw something for me. This is of course just my experience.

u/pinkenbrawn • 2 points • 2025-04-29 17:32 UTC

Kinda evens out if you would look in a larger scale. You wouldn't draw anyway, but you'd use AI, and someone is the opposite.

That's just my assumption, though, I don't think there's statistics and I'm not well-versed at it anyway.

u/adfx • 1 points • 2025-04-29 17:34 UTC

That could be very much the case! I am just happy to share my two cents here

u/laseluuu • 5 points • 2025-04-29 15:38 UTC

yep - They just try to blame environmental impact being bad, when they arent even looking at their own environmental impact - hypocrites

u/Amethystea • 7 points • 2025-04-29 15:07 UTC

The 2 biggest areas we could improve are agriculture and power generation. Data centers are incentivized towards greater power efficiency. It simply saves them a lot of money to be more efficient.